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Problem 1: Find the Promos

Why this problem

The pack is the first 50 timestamped episodes of one English show. A wrong start time can be checked against the script in a minute, which is a harder and fairer test than a polished demo. The same command can be pointed at a new show in an interview. I left the lawyer and the open problem aside for that reason.

What I built

A command-line script reads a folder of screenplays and writes a ranked list of promos. It does not cut picture, add music, or design titles. Each promo is one continuous stretch from a single episode. The output gives the episode, the start and end taken from the script, the hook, the cliffhanger, and one line on why a new viewer would stop.

How it works

1. Code parses each file into camera, action, sound, and dialogue beats. The clock times are copied from the screenplay, not estimated.
2. Code proposes windows of 20 to 60 seconds. A window must open on a spoken line or a physical action, and it must end on a spoken line.
3. Gemini sees only the four strongest windows in that episode. It may keep two. It writes the hook, the cliffhanger, and the reason. It is told not to move the timestamps and not to invent events.
4. If two kept windows in one episode overlap, the weaker one is dropped. The series is then ranked. The first ten are marked to post first.

Assumptions

A promo is one continuous stretch, not a montage, and it stays inside one episode. Twenty to sixty seconds is a hard bound. The hook is the opening beat of that window. Camera direction alone is not a hook. An editor still watches the top ten before anything is posted. Joined cuts, across one episode or several, were left out so the times stay easy to audit.

Tools, and the place the model was wrong

Cursor was used to write and revise the parser and the scorer. Gemini judged the shortlist. The free tier allows 20 requests a day for each model. `gemini-2.5-flash` is closed to new keys, and `gemini-3.8-flash` did not answer, so the run used `gemini-3.6-flash` and then `gemini-3.5-flash-lite`. The model name is a command flag.

On Episode 31 the spoken out-point is Juliana's line, "Then why are you so desperate to make me kneel?", which ends at 02:02.00. The action "the blow lands" starts at that same timestamp, so it is the next beat, not a moment inside the clip. Gemini wrote that the promo cuts on the blow. The timestamp stayed on a real screenplay boundary. The sentence stepped one beat past it. Gemini also kept a second Episode 31 window of the same scene, six seconds shorter. The overlap rule removed it. I would rather show that miss than smooth it over.

What I would post first

Fifty episodes produced 57 promos after the overlap pass. The first three:

1. Episode 31, 01:17.80 to 02:02.00 (44.2s). Opens on “You call that marriage?” The spoken cut is the kneel question above.
2. Episode 15, 00:07.60 to 00:55.70 (48.1s). Juliana finds thugs destroying her mother’s garden. The picture is doing the hook, not a slow line.
3. Episode 42, 00:25.50 to 01:12.40 (46.9s). Opens on “Why?!” as the guards refuse an order, and ends as Alexander is named the rightful duke. The opening word is thin. The next line, inside three seconds, supplies the stake.

How I know, and where it still fails

Every posted start and end was matched to a Start or End line in the screenplay. Every duration is inside 20 to 60 seconds. No two posted clips in one episode overlap. `quality_notes.json` is the list I would not ship without a look. Episode 18 ends on comfort after the beam falls, so the danger is already over. Episode 9 opens on a plea that the scorer itself calls soft. Episode 16 and Episode 10 end on a tender “are you hurt?”, which is a pause, not a cliffhanger. Episode 6 sounds finished.

The tool reads text. It cannot see whether a described slap is actually the first frame. A one-word shout can outrank a clearer line. A late hook is missed when fewer than 20 seconds remain. Standalone sense is estimated from who speaks, not from a viewer test.

Scale, and how to run it again

A new show is another folder. The model sees four short windows per episode, not the whole series, so a weekly slate is one call per episode plus a human pass on the top ten. Without a key, `--judge heuristic` still returns timestamps. From the prototype folder:

```
python find_promos.py --input PATH_TO_SHOW --output ..\raw_outputs
```

The submitted run is in `raw_outputs`. `series_ranking.md` is the posting order. `series_ranking.json` is the same list with the lines the judge saw. `quality_notes.json` is the untrusted set. `episodes` holds one unedited file per episode, including the windows Gemini rejected and why.

This folder also holds `prototype\find_promos.py` and this note. The episode files themselves are not in the folder. The outputs quote lines from them, so they should not be published.